

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience reviewing and amending commercial contracts, identifying legal and compliance risks, and managing case files and deadlines across complex matters. Practical background spans in-house contract review at Adobe, a one-year legal placement at BCLP supporting disputes and arbitration, and current client-facing advisory work at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Experienced in drafting correspondence and procedural documents, organising large volumes of confidential documents, coordinating with internal and external stakeholders, and translating complex legal requirements into clear practical guidance.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module covering data privacy and democracy: 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Adobe · London June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation, flagged provisions requiring legal input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for clients; advises on procedural requirements and options

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; tracked filings and matter deadlines using iManage
- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues, and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons; prepared client notes and maintained matter records

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; contract review and drafting; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters